

Assignment 4

Managing Disruptive Technologies

Objective

There are several objectives we want to collectively achieve through the group presentation of cases. First, it will provide us an opportunity to learn about a variety of technology and platform related topics and contexts which we weren't able to cover since this is only a mini-long core course. Next, it will provide an opportunity for students to get to know each other better, an aspect which is crucial for long term success. Finally, being able to work in groups is a key skill that we must continuously develop. Being able to digest and present information in a coherent manner is an important skill.

Administrative Details

Assignment 4 is in the form of a class presentation. It accounts for 15% of your overall grade. It has to be carried out in groups of 4 or 5 as detailed in the Canvas announcement. **The group number indicates which case you need to discuss.** The presentations will take place in Lecture 12 and 13 in week 7. There will be 5 presentations in each lecture decided by random draw. Presentation slides for all groups are due by **20th of April at 11.59 pm. One member per group should upload the slides on Gradescope. Mention SECTION and GROUP NUMBER as the file name.** The outline is as follows:

- (1) Each group will make a 7-minute presentation.
- (2) At least three members of the team need to present (more can present too).
- (3) After the presentation, there will be 2-3 minutes for questions. These questions will come from your classmates and myself. These questions will need to be answered by the non-presenting team mates (if any). The individual supposed to answer will be picked randomly.

The Case and the Presentation

The presentations of the cases should be clear and concise covering the following aspects. Consider these as general guidelines and make the necessary tweaks based on the case assigned.

- (1) Briefly outline the context and some details about the focal company. **(20 points)**
- (2) Highlight the core subject of the case. **(30 points)**
- (3) Discuss the main outcomes and strategic takeaways from the case. **(50 points)**
- (4) Conclude by extending the case (in potentially the following ways): **(50 points)**
 - (a) Drawing links with the **current day** situation for the firm or the industry
 - (b) Discussing strategic implications for **other companies** in the same or other industries.

Utilize terminology and concepts learnt during the course throughout the presentation.

Note that if you go over the 7-minute mark, then for each additional 30 seconds you will be penalized 3 points.

The point of the presentations is not the technical aspects or the nitty gritty details of these cases. As is the theme of the course, the main aim is to summarize the key takeaways so that we can further our understanding of technology platforms and their business strategies. Please utilize all the office hours of the TAs to get as much input and feedback as possible on different aspects. Feel free to get in touch with me if there is any way I can help.

I have provided a general rubric in terms of the points distribution across the different parts of the presentation. This is a simple guide and there could be deviations based on the presentation. The presentation will be graded as a whole with the above as a framework in mind. Hence, keep in mind how each part flows into the other and coherence required across the entire presentation.

Some (subjective) presentation and slides suggestions:

With a short presentation, the content and the slides have to be efficient. Try to move linearly through the content while building a coherent narrative. Repetition of points can be useful as a link between slides or presenters but not necessary, if sufficient effort has been put into making the slides and narrative clear. Lay a clear foundation with the introductory part of the presentation. Refrain from using screenshots of Figures and Tables from the case directly and try to simplify using your own representation of the same information. This will help you to not have extraneous details on the slides. Overall, use the slides to support your presentation and the point you're trying to make. You do not need to put every small detail on the slides. Make them neat and efficient so that your classmates can use it as a tool to follow along.

The list of Cases is below. The group number corresponds to the case you will discuss. For example, if you are group number 6, you will discuss the Safegraph case.

- (1) Racial Discrimination on Airbnb (A+B)
- (2) TikTok's AI Strategy
- (3) Uber and the Ethics of Sharing
- (4) AI Wars
- (5) Walmart Takes on Amazon
- (6) Safegraph
- (7) HubSpot (A+B)
- (8) Hugging Face (A+B)
- (9) Moderna
- (10) SmartOne: AI Data Business